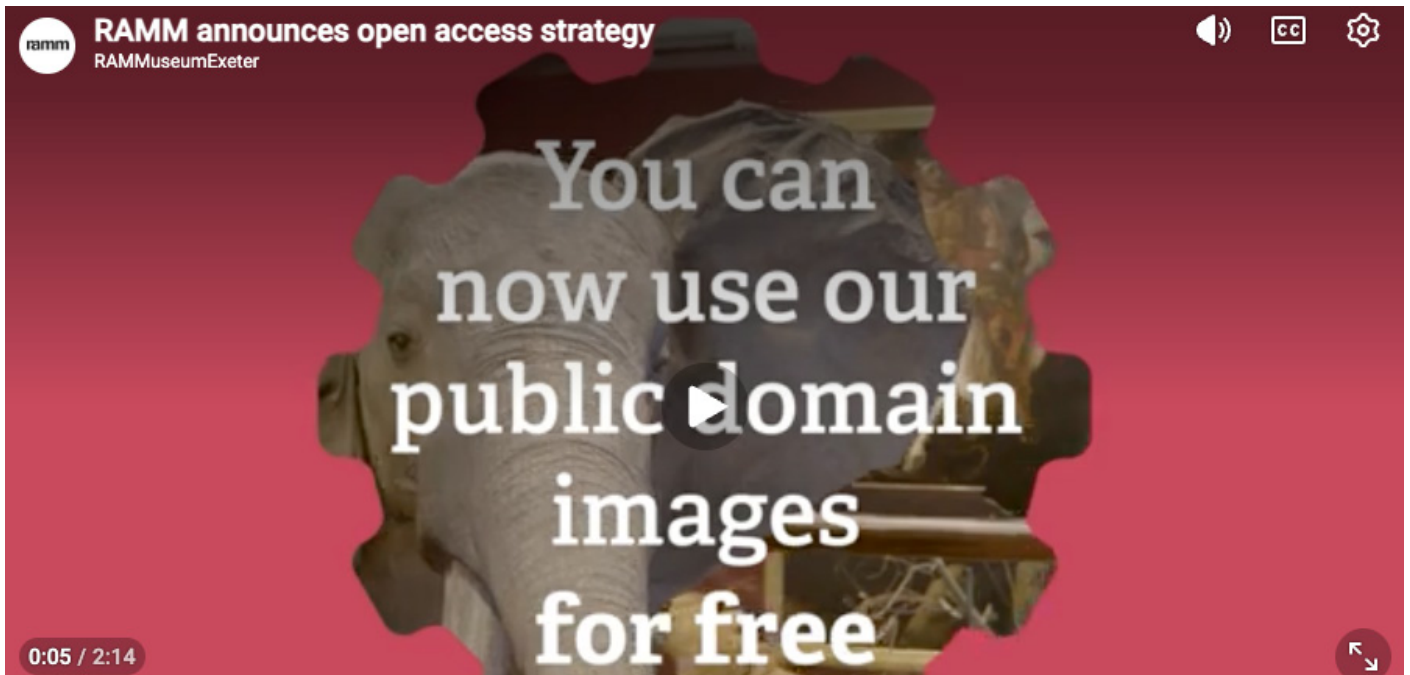


ramm



REPORT
18 Months of
Open Access
at RAMM





Executive Summary

Since February 2024 RAMM has been releasing batches of images open access and 3D models on RAMM's online collections database, 'Collections Explorer', Wikimedia Commons and SketchFab. In total, 18 batches of images were released themed around artists, exhibitions, holidays and locations. 10 3D models were released of 3D objects including a Georgian gentleman's suit, a beaver skull and a terracotta figure of Harpocrates. RAMM staff have been collecting data on the wider impact of the strategy to find out more about how going open access has affected RAMM and to inform future open access strategies.

This data collection includes news reporting, emails from interested parties, website analytics on the open access launch, how the images are used on Wikimedia sites, SketchFab and elsewhere, and the identified benefits of open access to RAMM and the wider heritage sector. Data was collected through Wikimedia's GLAMorgan tool, Google Analytics, Google reverse image searching, social media analytics and feedback from RAMM audiences, users and other members of the public. This report focuses on data collected between February 2024 to August 2025.

The main findings over this 18-month period include:

- A 85% increase in website visits to RAMM's website around the time of the open access announcement;
- A total of 12,880,510 Wikipedia page views of articles containing RAMM images; RAMM images featured across 32 different Wikipedia languages, including English, Portuguese, Slovak, Urdu and Korean;
- A total of 529 downloads of RAMM's open access 3D models from SketchFab;
- A further 11 local cultural heritage organisations uploading works open access in collaboration with RAMM.

Because this project proceeded as part of an AHRC-funded collaboration in partnership with the GLAM-E Lab, other outcomes with impact include a partnership with Wikimedia UK, follow on funding from AHRC, the publication of the Open GLAM Toolkit, collaborations with international heritage organisations and over 20 invitations to present on the project. This has resulted in bringing huge value back to RAMM through wider visibility. Following on from this work, RAMM is now considering possible next steps to continue this work and increase the availability of digital collections available online.

What is the project about?



Geranium by Emily Worthington

In February 2024, RAMM announced its [Open Access Strategy](#) developed in partnership with the [GLAM-E Lab](#) and law students at the University of Exeter.¹ Since then, it has been releasing medium-resolution images of public domain collections for free public reuse to [Collections Explorer](#) and [Wikimedia Commons](#) in the hope that people will use, remix and reuse them.²

Prior to the announcement, RAMM and the GLAM-E Lab spent 18 months researching open licensing and how it could be applied to RAMM's collections and collections management practices.

Key research questions included:

- What flexibilities, pressures or barriers impact whether smaller organisations adopt open access?
- Is image licensing actually profitable once the costs of doing business are accounted for?
- What new income sources might open up through open licensing?
- What information do decision makers need to appreciate the potential impact of open access for their organisation?
- And what new heritage management questions emerge from open access strategies?

Following on from this research, the team proposed a strategy that aimed to balance the commercial needs of the museum with its commitment to bring collections directly to the people of Exeter.



Indian oakleaf butterfly (Kalima) - Charles James Worthington



What is RAMM's Open Access Strategy?

Almond Blossom (detail), William Weaver Baker

As of February 2024, RAMM does not assert a new copyright in photographic reproductions of 2D objects or 3D models of 3D objects where those objects are no longer protected by copyright. By adopting this strategy, RAMM brings its approach to image rights management into compliance with UK copyright law.³

These digital images and 3D models are released using the [CC0 1.0 Public Domain Dedication](#).⁴ With respect to image resolution, the digital images are released at a minimum of 300 dpi when printed at A5. This resolution enables people to use these images for a wide range of purposes, from personal and research and contributing to the UK's Creative Economy. High resolution images are available to license through RAMM and Bridgeman Images at a cost. RAMM also makes images available for purchase through Art UK's print-on-demand services and images from RAMM's public domain collections were also included in Art UK's Open Access Project announcement.⁵ As part of the strategy, any original outputs or research data created by employees at RAMM is released open access under the [CC BY SA 4.0 International licence](#) wherever possible

RAMM adopted this strategy to:

1. Comply with copyright law;
2. Improve efficiencies and diversify income streams as many open access organisations have seen their income increase through the new opportunities which flow from international attention to collections and the commercial licensing of the brand;
3. Join the open GLAM movement through piloting a more scalable model for low-cost open access implementation and testing new business models that could better serve less well-resourced peers;
4. Explore new programming possibilities as funders are increasingly adopting policies which prohibit new copyright claims in faithful reproductions of public domain works or impose other open access obligations on funded projects.

Moreover, open access lets users access and use digitised public domain collections and contribute to the rich cultural heritage of Exeter, regardless of their location. RAMM wants people to be inspired, informed and entertained by the museum's collection and to use it to foster new knowledge, individual and cultural creativity. RAMM recognises the importance of providing access and information to the public to advance its mission and to unlock new cultural discoveries. RAMM has taken care to ensure that no in-copyright materials or sensitive works are included in these open access releases.⁶

How long did it take?

From start to finish, RAMM's open access adoption took 17 months. In Nov 2022, the project started with a roundtable of staff from four UK cultural organisations with similar open access approaches for digital collections.⁷ Following on from their advice and experiences, RAMM launched an open access pilot using 63 images in January 2023.⁸ The trial tested workflows and collected data using third-party platforms to understand the potential of open access for RAMM collections. This and other data along with the proposed strategy was submitted in a [report to the Exeter City Council Executive](#) in October 2023.⁹ The report outlined the business case for open access, including potential loss of income or legal risk which were identified as nominal.¹⁰ ECC approved the proposed strategy in November 2023, which was finalised and implemented by RAMM in the immediately following months (Table 1).

TABLE 1: Timeline of approval process

	Nov 2022	Dec 2022	Jan 2023	Feb 2023	Mar 2023	Apr 2023	May 2023	Jun 2023	Jul 2023	Aug 2023	Sep 2023	Oct 2023	Nov 2023	Dec 2023	Jan 2024	Feb 2024	Mar 2024
Roundtable																	
Trial and data collection																	
Development of open access strategy																	
Initial drafting of Committee Report																	
Negotiations with ECC Legal																	
Submission of Committee Report																	
Finalising of Open Access strategy																	
Announcement of Strategy																	

RAMM announced the new Open Access Strategy in February 2024,¹¹ and has continued to release new images monthly. This method allows the team to work through the process of clearing copyright and compiling the metadata that accompanies the images.¹² The monthly batches are released in themes (e.g., portraits, botanical illustrations, etc.), and are available to access on Collections Explorer and Wikimedia Commons.¹³

What has been done so far?



Clayhidon, Charles Ginner

Between February 2024 and August 2025, RAMM uploaded 1,306 CC0 images to Wikimedia Commons in batches (Table 2) and updated the public domain domain status of 3,528 images on Collections Explorer.¹⁴ By using the batch method, the team can identify smaller sets of images appropriate for release and prepare them for upload, such as by including Wikimedia QIDs¹⁵ and Templates in the metadata to maximise their findability and interoperability across Wikimedia platforms.¹⁶

TABLE 2: Batch uploads grouped by theme

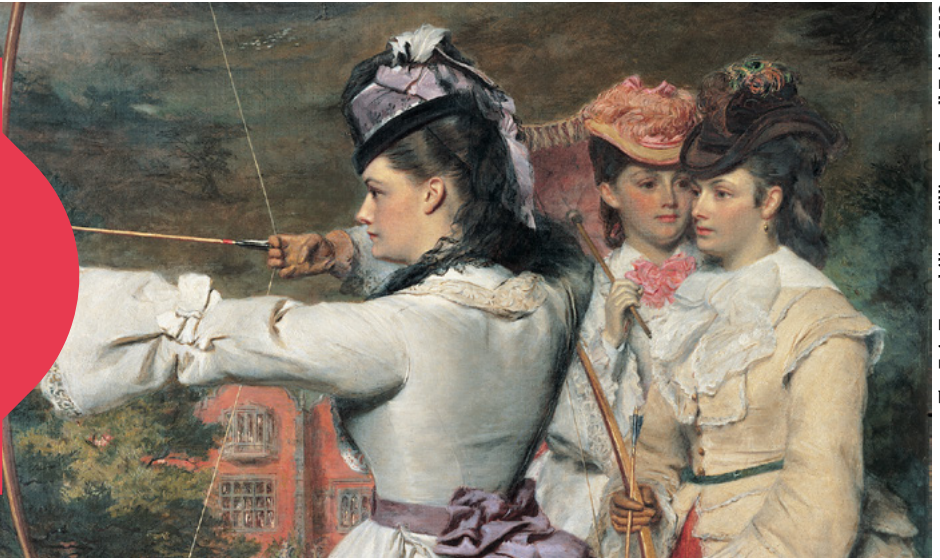
Person	RAMM event	Holiday	Other
Ann Lee (Batch 3)	Printmaking Exhibition (Batch 2)	World Wildlife Day (Batch 4)	Exeter (Batch 1)
William Weaver Baker (Batch 11)	Are We Nearly There Yet? Exhibition (Batch 7)	International Women's Day (Batch 5)	Portraits (Batch 8)
	Dartmoor: A Radical Landscape (Batch 9)	World Environment Day (Batch 6)	Summer (Batch 15)
	A Feast for the Eyes (Batch 12)	Remembrance Day (Batch 10)	
	RAMM's anniversary (Batch 13)	Coastal Clean Up Day (Batch 14)	
	Wild exhibition (Batch 16)	World Photography Day (Batch 17)	
		World Fungus Day (Batch 18)	

In September 2025, RAMM and other cultural heritage organisations launched the revamped [South West Collections Explorer](#) which includes the ability to download RAMM's open access images. This is also a forthcoming feature for Collections Explorer.



Goliath Beetle (the underside of) Ann Lee

How are the images being used?



The Fair Toxophilites William Powell Frith CVO

As part of the open access work at RAMM, the team has been collecting data on public engagement with the Open Access Strategy and images. This includes:

- Page view numbers of Wikipedia articles containing [RAMM's images](#).¹⁷
- Where and how images have been used online, via Google Analytics and reverse image search Engines (e.g., Google, TinEye).
- Website referrals, increase in activity and audience reach, via tracking data through RAMM's website, Collections Explorer and Google Analytics.
- Social media analytics from posts posted by RAMM relating to the open access work.¹⁸
- Image licensing income and operational costs to assess efficiency, opportunities for licensing (e.g., brand licensing, new partnerships) and direct revenue generation.
- Feedback from the public, ranging from local historians and business owners to university students who were taught about the strategy and museum visitors.¹⁹

What was learnt?

1. What was learnt about the decision to go open?

Immediately following the announcement, the team collected data on press and public interest to understand how the decision to go open was received.

[RAMM's press release](#) was picked up by industry leaders in national and global heritage sectors, including the UK's National Museums Directors Council, Museum Intellectual Property Digest and Museums Association, the USA's American Alliance of Museums, and the international organisation Creative Commons. Locally, the team were invited to speak on BBC Radio Devon and the Museums Journal published a featured article about RAMM's new Open Access Strategy. The announcement was shared by well-known art historians, researchers, heritage staff and other industry leaders in blogs, social media, listservs and other spaces. The team were invited to give presentations about the strategy and underlying research to over 400 professionals, practitioners and policymakers at workshops and conferences.²⁰

With respect to website analytics data, on the date of the announcement, rammuseum.org had a spike in traffic with a 116% increase in users (785 active users). The following few days also saw an increase with a 76% increase on 14 Feb 2024 (785 active users), a 62% increase on 15 Feb 2024 (722 users) and a 89% increase on 16 Feb 2024 (844 users).

For comparison the average number of active users daily in 2024 was 378 which resulted in an average 85% increase in website visitors in the week following the announcement (Table 3). Collections Explorer also had a notable spike in users with 128.8% more users than expected on the 13th February 2024 (135 users). The [video announcing the strategy](#) received 907 views and 28 likes on YouTube.

TABLE 3: RAMM daily website visitors

Website	Average before	Week following	The same week in 2025/2026
rammuseum.org	378	622 (64% increase)	662 (75% increase)
Collections Explorer	59	135 (128% increase)	70 (% increase)
South West Collections Explorer	10	11 (10% increase)	4 (60% decrease)

The open access announcement also generated a lot of public goodwill. The team received emails that RAMM’s open access work was ‘really interesting’ and the data generated from the trial as ‘very satisfying’. Others double-checked that they could use RAMM’s images for free and thanked RAMM.²¹ Local historians also claimed that the images uploaded are ‘*just worth browsing for the pleasure!*’.

2. What was learnt about how images are being used

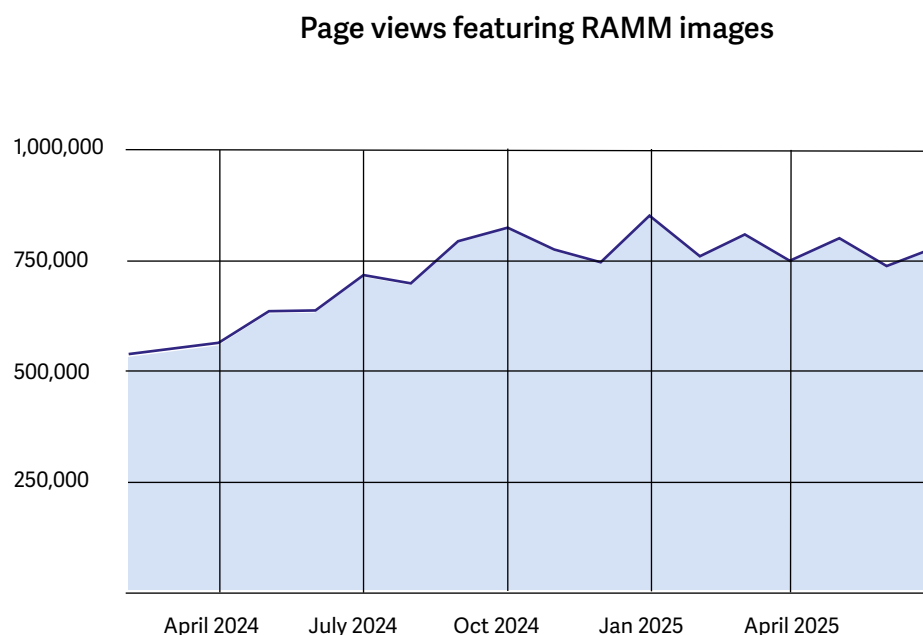
Wikimedia Platforms

Data collected between the launch of the open access strategy in February 2024 until August 2025 includes:

- Page views of Wikipedia articles with RAMM images
- The Wikipedia articles on which the images appear
- Who added them to the Wikipedia articles
- Distribution of RAMM content across Wikipedia languages
- Which batch of images has been most used

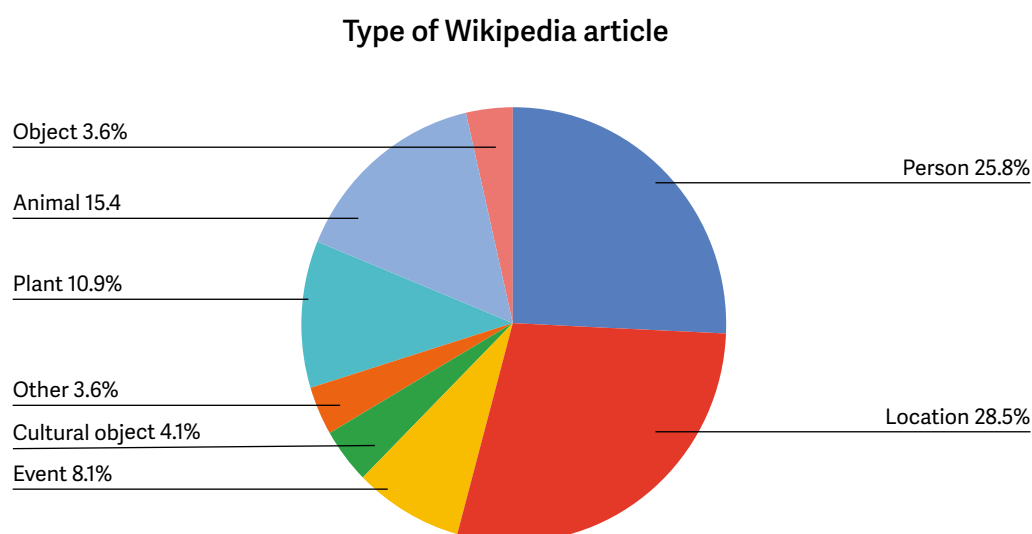
These metrics help illustrate how the images are used. Over the period of study RAMM’s images featured across articles that received 12,880,510 total views. (Figure 1) The number of views monthly increased steadily with each monthly upload. For comparison, the same images on Collections Explorer (rammcollections.org.uk) receive a tiny fraction of those views, which means the reach RAMM’s images on Wikipedia far exceeds the reach of Collections Explorer.

FIGURE 1: Type of Wikipedia article featuring RAMM images



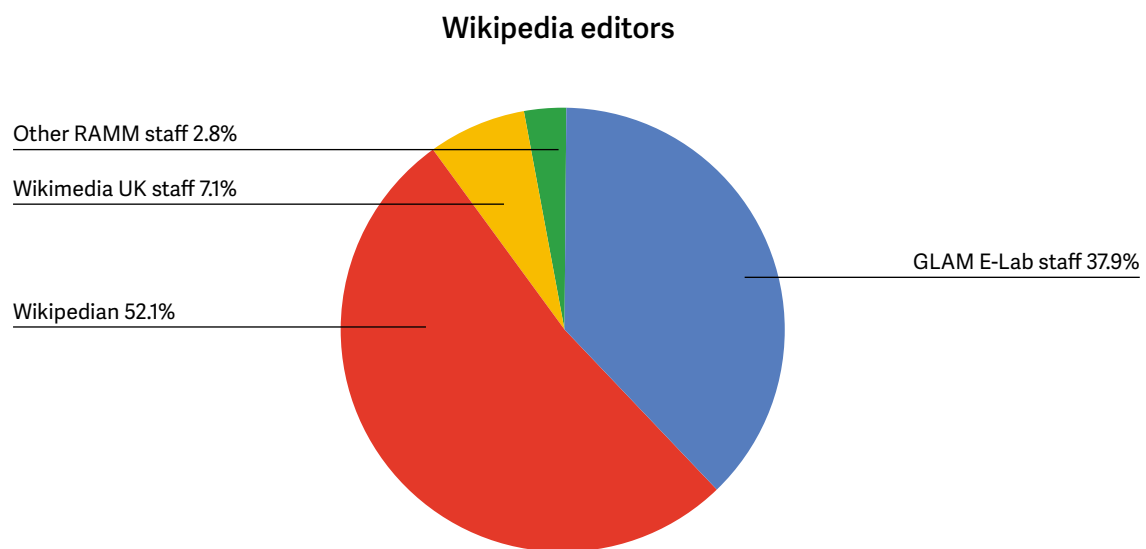
Of the 1,306 images uploaded, 11% (152) have been placed on 353 different Wikipedia articles. The most common type of Wikipedia article to include these images are distributed as: locations (28.5%) followed by people (25.8%), animals (15.4%) and plants (10.9%) (Figure 2). As RAMM's trial batch of images were predominantly of buildings and locations, this would explain why Wikipedia articles relating to locations are the most common. RAMM images were most frequently added to the English language Wikipedia but were included in 32 other Wikipedia language sites including the Cebuano²², Portuguese and Slovak. Because RAMM images and metadata are interoperable, they are also used across Wikidata, Wikiquote and Wiktionary. This means that people from all over the world have interacted with RAMM's images, raising the public profile of RAMM globally. As a regional museum, RAMM would never have been able to achieve this reach without Wikimedia platforms.

FIGURE 2: Type of Wikipedia article featuring RAMM images



As part of the project, RAMM hosted Lucy Hinnie, a Wikimedian in Residence from 2023-2024. This was funded initially by Wikimedia UK's [Connected Heritage project](#) which aimed to raise digital skills and confidence across the UK heritage sector. In 2024 the project was awarded follow-on funding from the AHRC which funded an extension of the partnership with Wikimedia UK. As part of this partnership, the team held in-person and online Wikipedia [Edit-a-thons](#) and also added RAMM's images to Wikipedia articles. The team found that if an image is placed on a Wikipedia article, it is more likely that Wikipedians will use that same image on a different relevant article or another article language. By tracking who placed the images onto the Wikipedia pages, the data showed Wikipedians were the most prevalent type of editors (52.1%), followed by the GLAM-E Team (37.9%) and then staff at Wikimedia UK (7.1%) (Figure 3).

FIGURE 3: Editors that added RAMM's images to Wikipedia articles

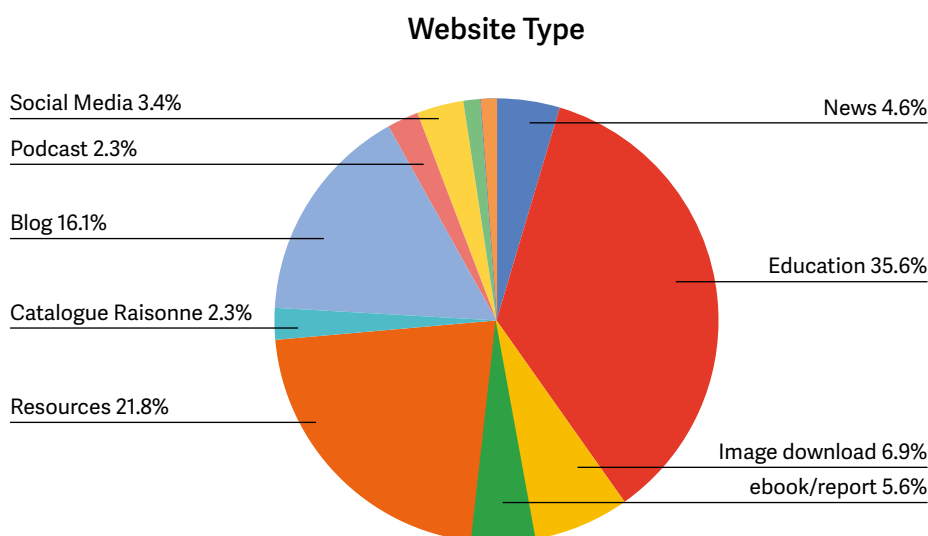


Some images that were uploaded were expected to be popular with Wikipedians. These images regularly feature in exhibitions, are oftentimes painted by well known artists or have been subject to a great deal of interest. These images include [The Fair Toxophilites](#) and [Portrait of a Man in a Red Suit](#). However, the team also found that images by lesser known artists and images that aren't popular on Collections Explorer were also used frequently by Wikipedians, including [The East Gate, Exeter and the Visit of King Richard III](#), [Cavalier Troops Mustering outside the Guildhall, Exeter](#), [The South Gate, Exeter - The Reception of King Edward IV, 1470](#) and [St. Sidwell's Church, Exeter, after the Blitz](#). What links the use of the lesser known images is that they each featured a specific event or story. This would suggest that cultural heritage organisations wanting to release open access images could focus on artworks that spotlight stories to increase their reuse.

Other Online Activity

To track wider online use, the team used reverse image searches to find other reuse examples across third party websites and platforms (Figure 4). This included a test sample of the top 75 images used on Wikipedia for reverse image searches. Of these 75 images, 36 appeared on third party websites. These are overwhelmingly on English language websites (85%) followed by Spanish (5.7%), Russian (2.3%) and Swedish (2.3%). The images appeared on education websites (35.6%), blogs on a range of topics (mostly on historical events and places, 16.1%), free image download sites (6.9%), ebooks and reports (4.6%) and news sites (4.6%). It is worth noting that a RAMM image was also included in Wikimedia UK's Strategic Report for 2024/2025.

FIGURE 4: Editors that added RAMM's images to Wikipedia articles



RAMM also worked with the University of Exeter's Digital Humanities Lab to digitise collections to create 3D models. In total, 10 models are available on [Sketchfab](#) under the CC0 1.0 Public Domain Dedication. These models include a Georgian suit and trousers, ancient Greek and Roman terracotta figures, a saddle cloth from the 1700s and a Victorian skirt lifter. These 10 models have been viewed 1,964 times and downloaded 529 times. This means that users can 3D print the models or import them digitally in videogames or 3D reconstructions. This work has also enabled RAMM to include the 3D media in exhibitions. RAMM's Wild exhibition included a [3D print of the beaver skull](#) model for visitors to touch alongside a tablet that provided access to the 3D model on Sketchfab for visitors to zoom in and explore.



Georgian gentleman's matching suit of coat, waistcoat and breeches digitised by the University of Exeter's Digital Humanities Lab

The team also documented any instances of the public contacting RAMM about image use and engagement. So far, people have contacted RAMM staff to let them know about:

- A self-published book by a local historian that uses one of RAMM's open access images for the cover.
- An exhibition at Topsham Museum that features in an open access image.
- A man finally identified the title and artist of a John White Abbott image after seeing it at a local pub he frequented for 20 years.
- An open access image of St Lawrence Church included in a tweet listing a man's family tree.
- The Exeter Red Coat tour guides who use RAMM's images of historical Exeter in their tours.
- Open access images have also been used on the very popular Exeter Memories Facebook page e.g., the use of Richard Holmyard for forgery on the City Bank taken for execution to the gallows in Magdalen Road 1818 and A Bird's Eye View of Wynards Hospital, Exeter.²⁵
- A lecture about the travels of an Iranian student in Georgian Exeter. A RAMM image was used in the event listing.²⁶
- Use of the Open Access Strategy in teaching in the UK and Ireland.²⁷

What else was learnt about impact?



Flower piece, Josina Margereta Weenix

Impact on licensing practices

RAMM also documented impact on licensing practices, including staff time, income and other data points.

While the Open Access Strategy releases medium-resolution images for free public reuse, RAMM has reserved high-resolution images and revised its fee structures around their use. Service fees go towards digitisation, administration and other ad hoc costs relating to the digital collections. The images are also available for people to license through Bridgeman Images.

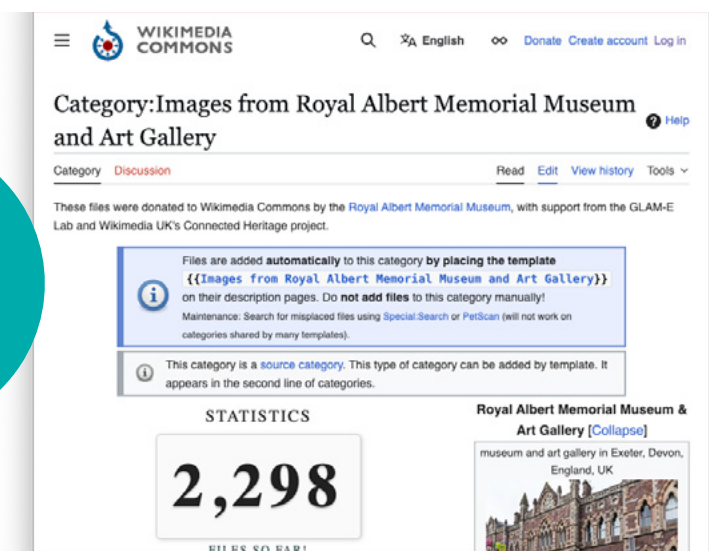
The income Exeter City Council receives from licensing RAMM images has reduced significantly since 2019. Fee payments were also primarily collected from researchers and educators who required images for publication and career advancement, rather than from commercial users or businesses. This trend is reflected within the wider cultural sector, as fewer people are willing to pay for images and many lack the funds to do so.

As itemised in Table 4 below, RAMM's Open Access Strategy has not affected ECC licensing income, as that income was already in decline. However, it is worth noting that image income through Bridgeman has remained relatively steady. This would suggest that people that are willing to pay for images are more likely to go through a third party.

TABLE 4: Income from image service fees at RAMM and Bridgeman

Year	ECC (£)	Bridgeman (£)
2019	7,014.80	610.12
2020	1,875.40	635.75
2021	1,243.99	532.92
2022	467.79	2,381.30
2023	2,049.38	883.78
2024	204.54	815.60

Impact on RAMM's website



RAMM was interested in whether the interest of the images on Wikimedia Commons would result in more interest in RAMM in general. In order to test this, the team uploaded the images Wikimedia Commons with links to Collections Explorer in their metadata. This meant that they have been able to track how open access uploads might positively impact traffic to its website.

[Collections Explorer](#) and the [South West Collections Explorer](#) have both received website traffic from Wikipedia, Wikimedia Commons and Wikidata. Collections Explorer received visitors from 9 different Wikipedia sites including English, Russian, Polish and Kazakhstan Wikipedia, increasing the global reach of RAMM's websites over the last three years. Moreover, South West Collections Explorer also received visitors from Russian Wikipedia. Combined, 2.4% of visitors were referred to RAMM websites from the Wikimedia ecosystem increasing RAMM's online visibility globally.

As well as an increase in visitors, RAMM wanted to test whether visitors from Wikimedia sites were engaged with the online collections. Using Google Analytics, the team were able to measure on-site engagement from all visitors and compare it to those referred to from Wikimedia sites. Website engagement refers to visitors that perform actions on websites such as clicking through content on websites or signing up for newsletters. Table 5 shows the increased level of engagement across all of RAMM sites from visitors from Wikimedia sites as opposed to other referrals. Across all sites, the team found that on average users referred to from Wikimedia sites were 41% more engaged than those from elsewhere.

TABLE 5: Engagement across RAMM sites from Wikimedia sites

Website	Wholesite		Wikimedia Referral	
	2024	2026	2024	2026
rammuseum.org	67.67%	73.67%	76.25%	82.35%
Collections Explorer	53.09%	58.8%	54.76%	70.00%
South West Collections Explorer	21.84%	56.44%	62.5%	No referral traffic from wiki

Wider impact



Cat Study, William Weaver Baker

The impact of RAMM's Strategy on the wider cultural heritage sector was also important to the team. When determining the open access strategy RAMM sought to position itself among peers in the open GLAM movement, globally and locally. RAMM is only the 9th cultural heritage organisation in the UK adopt an open access policy for all public domain collections, joining the ranks of Wellcome Collection, Birmingham Museums Trust, Royal Pavilion and Brighton Museums, Brighton and Hove, Aberdeen Art Museums & Galleries, York Museums Trust, Newcastle Libraries and National Library of Wales. As well as leading the way for open access nationally, RAMM has also been able to position itself as a regional leader in the South West by continuing to collaborate with the GLAM-E Lab and support another 11 UK cultural heritage organisations to release CC0 images on Wikimedia Commons.²⁸ Another two organisations have used RAMM's report to adopt their own versions of an open access policy.²⁹ Adopting the open access strategy at RAMM and working with other local cultural heritage organisations has raised the profile of the city while also promoting Exeter as a liveable, happy and healthy place to live for everyone. By releasing these images local cultural heritage organisations have given the images back to the community to use in ways that support inclusion and stimulate local economic and social growth.

Over the past year, RAMM has supported the upload of 2,726 images to Wikimedia Commons from 15 organisations in the UK, Netherlands and United States. As well as working with these cultural heritage organisations, the team have also supported Amgueddfa Cymru – Museum Wales in implementing an open access policy for their new image platform, Amgueddfa Cymru Images and in determining a workflow for uploading their images to Wikimedia Commons. Amgueddfa Cymru – Museum Wales is the first national institution to adopt an open access policy for public domain images and has greatly benefitted from the knowledge accrued by RAMM staff over the last few years.

Throughout this work over the last few years, the team have also developed the [Open GLAM Toolkit](#) for cultural heritage organisations. The DIY Open GLAM Toolkit is available for cultural organisations of any size wanting to take the first steps towards developing an open access strategy that costs as much, or as little, as they can afford. The GLAM-E Lab developed the toolkit after working with RAMM as well as 24 other organisations to support staff through the process of clearing copyright in an underlying work, the digitisation and its metadata with the goal of assigning a public domain dedication when it is lawful and appropriate to do so. They also walk staff through how to publish digital collections online and track public engagement using free online platforms, as well as how to update their policies afterwards. Since publishing the Toolkit at the end of 2024, the team have been made aware of a number of organisations using it including Shaftesbury Abbey in the UK and the Menil Collection in the United States.

The team has presented RAMM's open access work to a range of audiences globally. Throughout 2024 and 2025, RAMM staff and the GLAM-E Lab were invited to speak at conferences, webinars and other events. Over the course of 2025 the team also converted the Open GLAM Toolkit into a workshop which has been delivered to cultural heritage professionals around the world including Portugal, Belgium, The Netherlands and the UK. In total, this work has reached audiences in the UK, US, and Europe which has increased RAMM's reputation internationally. In addition to this, Europeana commissioned the GLAM-E Lab and RAMM staff to write a report on 3D Models and Rights Management to support the provision of 3D content to Europeana.eu in line with the Recommendation on a common European data space for cultural heritage.

In recognition of this work, the team has won two awards. In 2024, RAMM's and the GLAM-E Lab's partnership with Wikimedia UK won the [Wikimedia UK Partnership of the Year award](#). The award highlighted the team's championing of Wikipedia and the potential it has for cultural heritage organisations which is something that will have long-lasting and deeply felt positive impacts for the profile of WMUK in the cultural heritage sector. In 2025, the team won the [Widening Reach award](#) at the GW4 Open Research Prize for the innovative work in opening up cultural heritage collections, using legal frameworks and legal support to enable smaller less well-resourced organisations to open up their collections for researchers and the public.



A Branch with Apples, William Cruickshank

What next?



Jackfruit, unknown

RAMM is now reflecting on this experience and looking into next steps to make collections more available to the public.

This includes:

- **Track downloads from the South West Collections Explorer.**

At the end of 2025, RAMM launched the updated South West Collections Explorer which allows users to download open access images directly from the website. Over the next year RAMM will monitor how many people are using this feature and will seek feedback on it.

- **Using Wikimedia platforms to improve metadata.**

Using Wikidata ³⁰ to increase the amount of data RAMM has relating to collections and those that created them to develop the metadata the museum currently has.

- **Extending the open access strategy.**

RAMM is continuing to monitor the data on the impact of the Open Access Strategy.

RAMM may consider applying CC0 also to photographic images of 3D objects where that object is in the public domain.

- **Make use of alternative labels and licensing.**

For images that RAMM can't release under CC0 for ethical reasons, it is looking into alternative labels and licensing.

Notes

- 1** The GLAM-E Lab is a joint initiative between the University of Warwick School of Law and the Engelberg Center on Innovation Law & Policy at NYU Law. It uses direct representation to develop model policies and terms for cultural institutions that are creating open access programs. The GLAM-E Lab was based at the University of Exeter until 2025, when it moved with UK Director Dr Andrea Wallace to the University of Warwick. Law students undertook an audit of RAMM's website and prepared a strategy as part of a module taught in the Cultural Heritage Law and Digitisation lab at the University of Exeter Law School.
- 2** Until 2023, RAMM published images of varying resolutions on Collections Explorer, some of which included copyright watermarks. RAMM also used a complicated pricing structure to license images for a range of uses, which required staff support to manage request and only produced income of £30-50 around 20% of the time.
- 3** This approach is consistent with UK copyright law, as clarified by the THJ v Sheridan Court of Appeal judgement (THJ Systems Limited & Anor v Daniel Sheridan & Anor (2023) EWCA Civ 1354), which found that a work must be the 'author's own intellectual creation' to receive copyright protection. This means that for any faithful reproduction of a public domain artwork: There must be scope for creative (rather than technical) choices to be made during stages of pre-production, production and post-production; That sufficient creative choices are, in fact, made; and Those creative choices result in a new work that is imprinted with the maker's personal stamp and is therefore their own intellectual creation, rather than a faithful reproduction of an existing work. Andrea Wallace and Francesca Farmer (2024) 3D Models & Rights Management: A Report on Copyright and Other Rights Assessments for 3D Models in Europeana. Available at: <https://pro.europeana.eu/post/3d-models-and-rights-management-report>.
- 4** Creative Commons recommends using the CC0 1.0 Public Domain Dedication for faithful photographic reproductions of public domain works. This is because some countries recognise copyright, database or related rights in artwork reproductions or the metadata they hold. RAMM wanted its digitised public domain artworks to be freely downloaded, reused, circulated, modified and shared without restrictions and by anyone who finds them. CC0 1.0 allows RAMM to reassure users in those countries that they can engage with the collections without risk.
- 5** Over the last year, RAMM has also made more works available for print-on-demand through [Art UK](#).
- 6** More information about RAMM's Open Access Strategy for digital surrogates of public domain objects can be found on the [RAMM website](#).
- 7** For more details, see [Making the Business Case for Open Access Whitepaper](#).
- 8** The open access pilot involved uploading 63 already digitised public domain artworks related to the city of Exeter and surrounding areas Wikimedia Commons. This enabled RAMM to track public engagement using Wikimedia's tools BaGLaMa and GLAMorgan. By the end-of-year, the data showed the 63 images had received over 6.16 million views. At least 41 had been added to 65 Wikipedia articles in 7 different languages, including Richard III, the English Civil War and the Baedeker Blitz.
- 9** The report was reviewed by many departments including ECCs finance and legal departments, it was submitted with their approval to the ECC Executive. [Public Access to Images of RAMM Collections](#), Exeter City Council Report, Camilla Hampshire, Julien Parsons, Andrea Wallace, Francesca Farmer, 2023.
- 10** [Public Access to Images of RAMM Collections](#), Exeter City Council Report, Camilla Hampshire, Julien Parsons, Andrea Wallace, Francesca Farmer, 2023. More information on this process can be found on the ECC website.
- 11** Before the announcement on the 12th Feb 2024, RAMM and the University of Exeter worked together to craft a press release and video announcing the Open Access Strategy which was sent to contacts and news outlets to generate buzz and interest in the open access work.
- 12** RAMM continues to digitise collections, there are a number of public domain objects for which there is no digitised image; these will be digitised when requested by users.
- 13** A request is included to users that they credit the 'Royal Albert Memorial Museum & Art Gallery' so others can identify the source of the material. For an example, see Section 3 of RAMM's Open Access Strategy. <https://rammuseum.org.uk/wp-content/uploads/2024/02/Open-access-strategy-accessible-1.pdf>
- 14** These batches consist of between 50 to 150 images to celebrate a specific event, person or place. By uploading the images in batches, RAMM is able to pace the copyright clearance and metadata preparation for each release.
- 15** To learn more about Wikidata QIDs visit the [Wiktionary page](#).
- 16** By including [Wikidata QIDs](#) and [Templates](#), data is interoperable across the Wikimedia ecosystem and easier for Wikipedians to find and use.
- 17** In 2015 GLAMorgan was created by Magnus Manske as a tool to produce Wikimedia Commons pageviews for a given category. Data includes view numbers for pages that include images from a specific Commons category and the type of Wiki the files have been used on (e.g. Wikidata, Wikipedia, Wikiquote)
- 18** Data taken from Meta's analytics tools for Facebook and Instagram
- 19** RAMM's open access strategy has been taught at the University of Exeter in history and at University College Cork in digital humanities. 20 Including the Cultural Heritage Open Scholarship Network in the UK 2024 (20 people), Open Copyright Education Advisory Network in the US 2024 (200 participants), CIDOC 2024 (5 people), Europeana Public Domain Day 2025 (15 people), GLAM-Wiki Lisbon 2025 (X), Europeana Copyright Office Hours 2025 (50 people), UK-Ireland Digital Humanities Association Conference 2024 (100 people).
- 20** Including the Cultural Heritage Open Scholarship Network in the UK 2024 (20 people), Open Copyright Education Advisory Network in the US 2024 (200 participants), CIDOC 2024 (5 people), Europeana Public Domain Day 2025 (15 people), GLAM-Wiki Lisbon 2025, Europeana Copyright Office Hours 2025 (50 people), UK-Ireland Digital Humanities Association Conference 2024 (100 people).
- 21** Independent scholars and historians don't have the budget to pay for image fees so before the adoption of open licensing they would find an alternative to RAMM's images.
- 22** Cebuano is an Austronesian language primarily spoken in the Visayas region of the Philippines.
- 23** Mostly historical resources such as land registries (21.8%).
- 24** See <https://2025strategicreport.wikimedia.org.uk/strategic-theme-3>
- 25** The Facebook page has 41,200 members, available at https://www.facebook.com/groups/exetermemories/?locale=en_GB
- 26** <https://www.eventbrite.co.uk/e/an-iranian-student-in-georgian-exeter-lecture-by-dr-nile-green-tickets-1984617007895?aff=oddttdtcreator#location>
- 27** At the University of Exeter in history and at University College Cork in digital humanities.
- 28** Russell-Cotes Art Gallery & Museum, Shaftesbury Abbey Museum and Gardens, Bristol Museums, Devon and Exeter Institution, Topsham Museum, University of Bristol Library Collections, University of Bristol Theatre Collection, University of Exeter Fine Art Collection, University of Exeter Special Collections, Museum of Policing in Devon and Cornwall and South West Heritage Trust.
- 29** University of Exeter Fine Art Collection and Shaftesbury Abbey Museum and Gardens.
- 30** Wikidata is a free and open knowledge base that can be read and edited by both humans and machines.



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